

Friends of the forest

A forest is home to many living things. Some animals feed on trees, but others protect them by eating their enemies. This is called “mutualism” because both the animals and the trees benefit from each other.

Forests also benefit humans, who in turn can help protect these natural treasures.

Best bird friends

Forests offer birds safe places to nest as well as plenty of food. In return, birds like the chickadee eat the insects that nibble on tree leaves or suck sap. Other birds eat and scatter a tree’s seeds so that new trees begin to grow.

Guarding ants

Whistling thorn acacia trees have special hollow spaces at the base of their spines where ants can nest. In return for their free homes, the ferocious stinging ants keep away leaf eaters, such as antelopes.

